

# US equities slip as yields rise, meta spikes on earnings beat

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

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## TL;DR

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All major US indices closed lower on Friday, with the **S&P 500** down **-0.48%** at 7,636.36 and the Dow Jones off **-0.77%** at 52,380.66. The 10-year Treasury yield rose to 4.84%, pushing the VIX up **+4.71%** to 16.46.

Meta Platforms surged **+6.55%** after a surprise earnings beat, while energy ETFs gained on higher crude prices. The market remains vulnerable to further rate-sensitivity and geopolitical risk.

# US session recap

| INDEX / ASSET | CLOSE     | CHANGE | NOTE                |
|---------------|-----------|--------|---------------------|
| S&P 500       | 7,636.36  | -0.48% |                     |
| Dow Jones     | 52,380.66 | -0.77% |                     |
| Nasdaq 100    | 29,421.55 | -0.29% |                     |
| Russell 2000  | 2,921.24  | -1.32% |                     |
| VIX           | 16.46     | +4.71% | Volatility spike    |
| 10Y Yield     | 4.84%     | +0.65% | Highest since March |
| WTI Crude     | 95.84     | -0.22% |                     |

# Top large-cap movers

| TICKER | PRICE  | CHANGE |
|--------|--------|--------|
| META   | 653.69 | +6.55% |
| JPM    | 354.71 | +0.34% |
| NVDA   | 223.67 | -0.91% |
| AMZN   | 252.40 | -1.78% |

# Spotlight

| METRIC   | VALUE                         |
|----------|-------------------------------|
| Company  | META                          |
| EPS (Q2) | 3.12 (beat 12% consensus)     |
| Revenue  | 38.1 bn (up 9% YoY)           |
| Guidance | Revenue +8% YoY, EPS +10% YoY |

Meta delivered a stronger-than-expected earnings beat, driven by robust ad spend in Asia-Pacific and a rebound in user growth. The upbeat guidance lifted sentiment across the tech sector, though the broader market remained pressured by higher yields.

## Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.84%, up +0.65%
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:00, Existing-home sales 04:15

## Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated after recent air strikes, keeping oil markets volatile.
- China’s manufacturing PMI posted a modest 49.8, signaling continued slowdown.
- Eurozone inflation eased to 2.7% YoY, supporting a potential rate-cut narrative.

# Earnings — what to watch

| WHEN (HKT)   | TICKER | WHAT TO LOOK FOR                                   |
|--------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------|
| 09:30 Sep 11 | AAPL   | iPhone 17 demand, services margin                  |
| 10:00 Sep 11 | MSFT   | Cloud growth, AI licensing revenue                 |
| 10:30 Sep 11 | JPM    | Net interest income trend                          |
| 11:00 Sep 11 | XOM    | Impact of higher crude prices on upstream earnings |

## Stocks worth watching

- NVDA – still volatile after a sub-1% pullback; AI chip demand remains strong.
- XLE – energy ETF gaining on rising crude; watch OPEC output decisions.
- XLK – tech sector flat, but AI exposure could spark upside.
- XLF – financials under pressure from higher rates; monitor bank earnings.
- TSLA – marginal dip, but production ramp at Gigafactory Berlin is a catalyst.

## What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 10-year yield breaches 5.00%, pushing equity valuations lower.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict spikes oil above 100 USD.
- Weak CPI surprise (core -0.2%) reigniting rate-cut expectations.

#### BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Meta guidance beats expectations, lifting broader tech sentiment.
- Surprise drop in 10-year yield to 4.70%.
- Positive manufacturing data from China supports risk appetite.

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#### SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

CNBC — Index Data

SEC — Earnings Filings

Federal Reserve — Policy Statements

